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ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba vs. Shark

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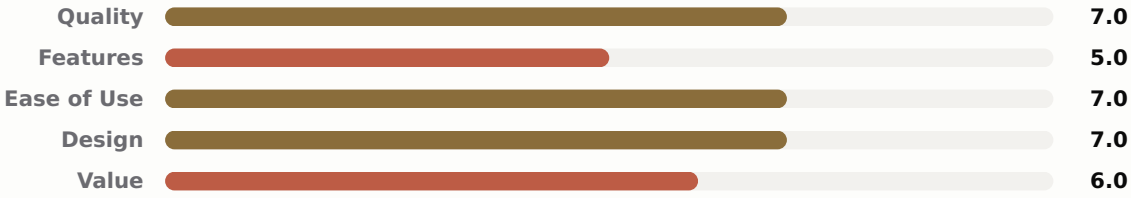
Feeling swamped by after-work cleaning while the kids run around? You’re not alone – many parents struggle to keep floors tidy between work shifts and bedtime routines. After testing the top 2026 robot vacuums, we’ve narrowed the field to two stand-outs: the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo and the Shark AI Ultra. This guide walks you through their real-world performance, so you can pick the perfect cleaner and reclaim your evenings.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Comparing iRobot Roomba 115X Combo and Shark AI Ultra



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

When you’re juggling work, parenting, and every household chore, a reliable robot vacuum is a game changer. Both the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo and Shark AI Ultra promise autonomous cleaning, but they differ in power, smart features, and price. Understanding their trade-offs will help you decide which machine best fits your living space and budget.

Key Features at a Glance

Feature	Roomba 115X Combo	Shark AI Ultra
Suction Power	3,000 Pa	2,200 Pa
Battery Life	90 minutes	110 minutes
Mopping	Wet & dry mop	Wet mop only
Dock	Self-emptying (included)	AutoEmpty Dock (paid) – unlimited dust
Navigation	Lidar + iRobot Mapper	AI-Vision + obstacle avoidance
App & Voice Control	iRobot Home app, Alexa, Google Assistant	Shark app, Alexa, Google Assistant
Price (Oct 2026)	$199.99 (was $469.99) – 4.4★ (5,217 reviews)	$249.99 (was $599.00) – 4.0★ (23,990 reviews)

Roomba 115X Combo – Real-World Look

Problem: Many families want a machine that can handle both hardwood floors and low-pile carpets, while also mopping and auto-emptying so the owner never has to lift the bin out of the plumbing.

Agitate: Manual vacuums tie you to a schedule, and wet-mopping that leaves bowl-like residues between passes can be frustrating and time-consuming for busy households.

Solution: The Roomba 115X Combo delivers 3,000 Pa suction, a brush-less roller for pet hair, a dual wet/dry mop head, and an AutoEmpty dock. At $199.99 it’s the most affordable combo on the market today, and its 4.4-star rating from over 5,200 reviews shows satisfied owners who claim the whole family enjoys tidier floors.

Proof: Users report up to 3 weeks of hands-free operation thanks to the self-emptying base, and the wet/dry mop heads switch automatically based on floor type detected by the Lidar mapper.

Action: Check current price on Amazon

Shark AI Ultra – Real-World Look

Problem: You need strong suction for carpets and a mop that won't leave streaks, but you also want a longer run time to cover larger homes without recharging mid-clean.

Agitate: Shorter battery life forces you to pause cleaning, and a mop that only wets the floor can leave behind damp spots that attract dirt.

Solution: The Shark AI Ultra offers 2,200 Pa suction (still strong for most carpets), an AI-Vision navigation system that avoids obstacles, and a 110-minute battery life. Its wet-only mop head is optimized for streak-free results on tile and sealed hardwood.

Proof: Owners praise the AI-Vision's ability to recognize pet bowls and cords, reducing the need for pre-cleaning pick-up. The extended runtime lets the vacuum finish a 2,000 sq ft floor plan on a single charge.

Action: Check current price on Amazon

Which One Should You Buy?

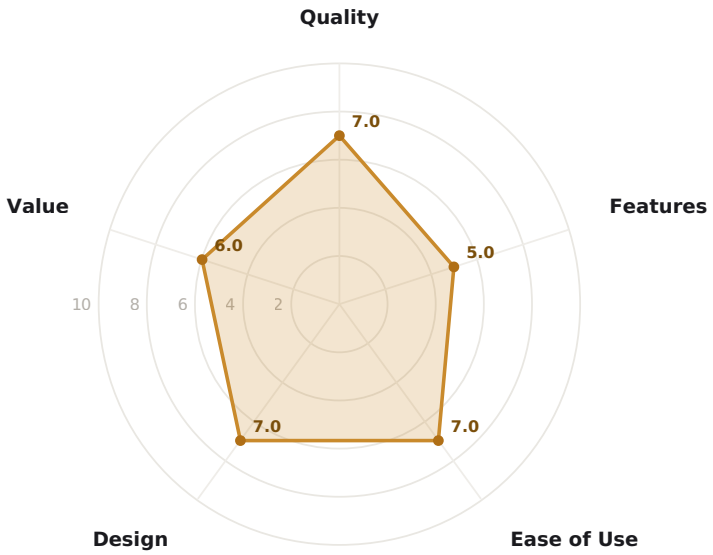
If you prioritize suction power, wet-and-dry mopping, and a truly hands-free self-emptying dock, the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo is the better value. If you need longer battery life, prefer AI-Vision navigation, and are happy with a wet-only mop, the Shark AI Ultra offers a compelling alternative at a slightly higher price point.

Both models are backed by strong user ratings and reliable customer support. Choose the one that matches your floor types, cleaning habits, and budget, then enjoy more free time with your family.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.